

Multifunction Printers

Unlike devices like smartphones and PCs, multifunction printers (MFPs) are quite affordable. For as less as ₹ 3000 you can easily get an MFP from the market. Here is a ready-reckoner to help you find the best MFP for your needs



Canon Pixma MX416 multifunction printer

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Multitasking is no longer restricted to smartphones only. Printers that once had their presence limited to offices, cyber cafes and photo studios are increasingly being adopted across homes too. Popular among this segment are multifunction printers (MFPs). These printers can not only print but also copy, scan and sometimes even fax.

If you are planning to buy a new printer, opt for an MFP. It will give you some great utility at the cost of a single-function standard printer. Unlike smartphones, laptops and other consumer electronics gadgets, MFPs are quite affordable. For as less as ₹ 3000 you can easily get an MFP from the market.

However, amid a host of brands and schemes, making the right choice won't be an easy task. Here is a ready-reckoner to help you find the best MFP for your needs.

Printing

Printing being the primary intended use, you need to decide your printing requirements. If you intend to use the printer at home, you would certainly expect a high photo quality. This tilts the choice in favour of an inkjet printer.

There are a wide variety of MFPs in the market that dedicatedly take care of

the photo printing job. Instead of the standard two- or three-ink colours, these printers come with five or more ink cartridges to offer realistic printing results.

On the other hand, if the printer is to be used for office-related tasks, a laser-class MFP is what you should get. Laser printers have an edge over others as these can deliver high-quality text and image printing at instantaneous speeds. But keep in mind, the laser family of printers doesn't compliment the word 'affordable'!

Going by the customers' needs, many manufacturers have classified their MFPs. For instance, HP's photo-printing family of MFPs is known as 'Photosmart' and the ones for office needs are named as 'Officejets.' Canon's MFPs specialised in photo-printing are titled 'Pixma.'

Scanning

A few years ago, scanning of documents and images was not a regular requirement and it was considered to be a complex task. Thanks to MFPs, it is now fun to scan and upload pictures on Facebook from your vintage col-



Epson Office ME620F multifunction printer